Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠K

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥K

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣J

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ K Q J 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ Q 10 8

♠ J 10 8 2
♥ 9 8 6 5 2
♦ 7 4
♣ 7 3



♠ 6 5 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 9 5 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 4
♥ A 7
♦ K 8 3
♣ K J 9 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♦Q

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

SOUTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If NORTH has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if NORTH has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells NORTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here NORTH bids the slam.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 10 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ A 8 5

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6



♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	Pass	1♠	Pass
3♠			
All Pass			

3♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

WEST has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when EAST opens 1♠ WEST should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

EAST has just 13 points, and knowing WEST has less than 13 he passes.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 7 3 ♥ Q 8 6 4 2 ♦ A 8 6 ♣ K 9 5	
♠ K Q J 4 ♥ 10 ♦ J 10 7 4 3 ♣ 10 8 4	N W E S	♠ A 9 6 5 ♥ J 9 ♦ 9 2 ♣ A J 7 3 2
	♠ 10 8 2 ♥ A K 7 5 3 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ Q 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

After SOUTH opens with 1♥, NORTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 4 ♥ K Q 10 6 3 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ A 7 4	
♠ K 10 8 3 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ Q J 3		♠ Q J 7 5 ♥ A ♦ A K Q 3 ♣ K 10 6 2
	♠ A 6 2 ♥ 9 8 5 4 ♦ J 7 5 ♣ 9 8 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥K

EAST has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

WEST has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

EAST now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K Q J 7 4 ♥ K Q 2 ♦ A J 6 ♣ 9 3	
♠ A 5 ♥ A J 9 8 ♦ K 8 5 ♣ Q 8 7 5		♠ 8 2 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ J 10 2
	♠ 10 9 6 3 ♥ 7 5 4 ♦ Q 7 ♣ A K 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣J

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

NORTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. SOUTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. NORTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. SOUTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.